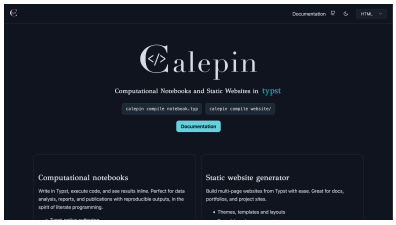
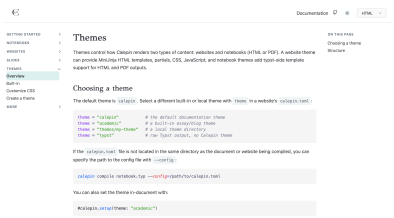
Themes

Themes control how *Calepin* renders websites and notebooks. A theme can provide MiniJinja HTML templates, partials, CSS, JavaScript, and a Typst-side `layouts/pdf.typ` layout for paged (PDF or SVG) notebook output. The default theme is called `calepin`.

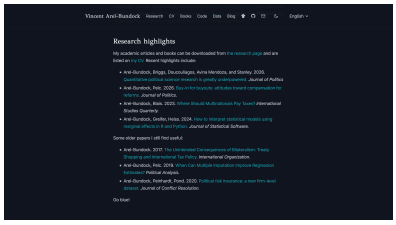
Theme customization uses one mechanism: create a local theme directory and point `calepin` to it when compiling.



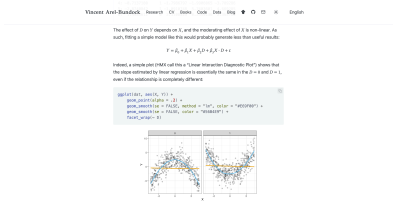
Calepin website theme in dark mode



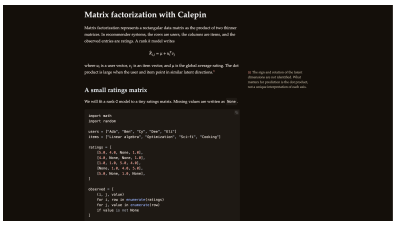
Calepin website theme in light mode



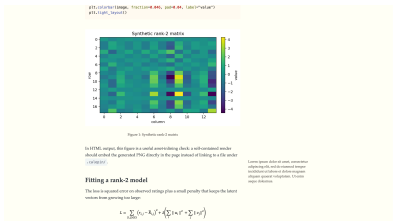
Academic website theme in dark mode



Academic website theme in light mode



Tufte notebook theme in dark mode



Tufte notebook theme in light mode

Choose a theme

Select a built-in or local theme with `theme` in `calepin.toml`:

```
# built-in themes
theme = "calepin"            # default documentation
theme = "academic"           # essay/blog
theme = "typst"              # raw Typst output; no styling

# a local theme directory
theme = "themes/my-theme"
```

Point `calepin` to your theme of choice by using the `--config` flag:

```
calepin compile notebook.typ --config=/path/to/calepin.toml
```

You can also set the theme in-document with, a setting which will take precedence over `calepin.toml`:

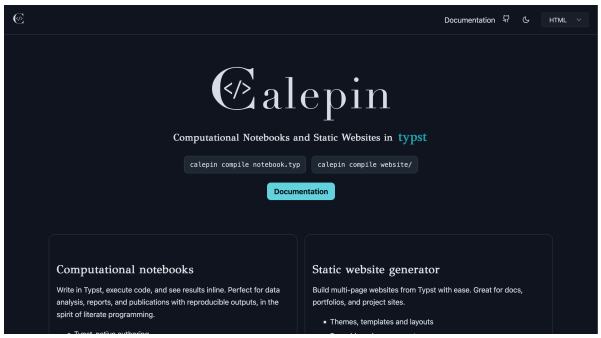
```
#calepin.setup(theme: "academic")
```

Calepin ships with built-in themes compiled into the binary. They are always available by name and can be selected without adding theme files to your project.

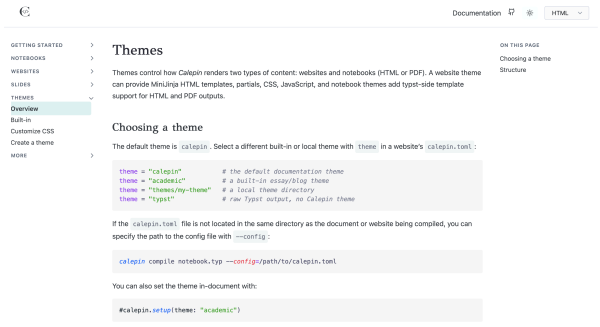
`calepin`

`calepin` is the default documentation theme. It is designed for project documentation, manuals, notebook collections, and sites where navigation and reference lookup matter.

It includes sidebar navigation, a top bar, previous and next page links, an on-page table of contents, dark mode, copy buttons on code blocks, and rendered, source, and PDF view switching.



Calepin theme dark website

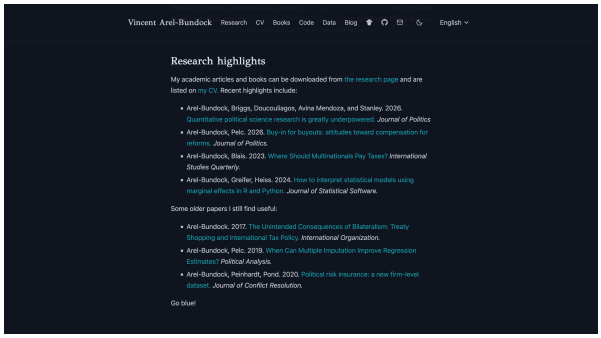


Calepin theme light website

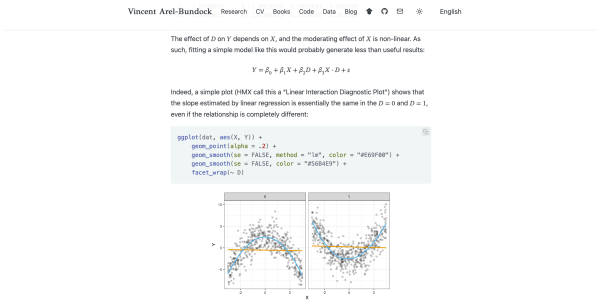
`academic`

`academic` is a reading-first essay and blog theme. It is designed for articles, research notes, project blogs, and smaller websites that prioritize long-form reading over dense navigation.

It includes a centered narrow text column, margin-note support, top navigation, dark mode, copy buttons on code blocks, and the shared Calepin search and language controls.



academic theme dark website



academic theme light website

`typst`

`typst` disables the website and notebook themed wrappers and uses raw Typst output. Use this when you want unstyled HTML or PDF output.

How to build or customize a theme

A theme is a directory with templates, resources, and a manifest. A minimal theme could look like this, with only a `theme.toml` manifest and one CSS stylesheet:

```
my-theme/
  theme.toml
  css/
    site.css
```

A custom theme *must* extend one, and only one, built-in theme. This inheritance is specified explicitly in the `theme.toml` manifest:

```
extends = "academic"
# extends = "calepin" # full website with navigation
# extends = "typst"   # bare bones HTML and PDF; no styling
```

A fuller theme can provide any of these files:

```
my-theme/
  theme.toml            # theme metadata and inheritance
  layouts/
    site.html           # website page wrapper
    document.html       # standalone notebook HTML wrapper
    site-landing.html   # optional page-specific website layout
    pdf.typ             # PDF/SVG Typst layout around notebook source
```

```
partials/
  ...                # reusable MiniJinja fragments
css/
  ...                # theme CSS
js/
  ...                # theme JavaScript
```

All the files in your custom theme are optional, except for the `theme.toml` manifest. When a file is present, it overrides the built-in theme file of the same name. When a file absent, it falls back to the built-in theme. New CSS and JavaScript files are appended in sorted order after inherited files.

Get started

A good way to start building a theme is to "eject" one of the built-in themes into your project. This copies all of the built-in theme's files into a local directory where you can modify or delete them. To start a new theme based on `academic`, run:

```
calepin new theme /path/to/my_theme --theme=academic
```

Modify the files in your `my_theme` directory, then point your `calepin.toml` at it:

```
theme = "/path/to/my_theme/"
```

Finally, render your document or website using the new theme:

```
calepin compile notebook.typ --config calepin.toml
```